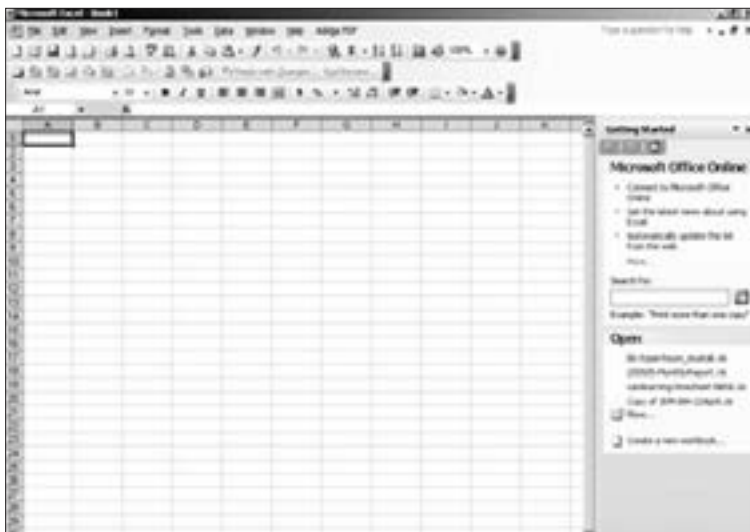


3.1 Introduction To Excel 2003



This is what a blank Excel spreadsheet looks like

Microsoft Excel is a member of the spreadsheet family of software. Spreadsheet software is used to store information in columns and rows that can then be organised and/or processed. Spreadsheets are designed to work well with numbers, but often include text. Sometimes text in a spreadsheet is called a label, because it is labelling columns and rows of numbers. Numbers are sometimes called values, and can include numbers for counts or measurements, dates, times, and calculations from numbers.

Spreadsheets can help organise information, like alphabetising a list of names or other text or reordering records according to a numeric field. However, spreadsheets are more often used for calculating, such as totalling a column of numbers, or generating a more sophisticated formula to calculate some statistical measures on a list of numbers.